WEEK 3 · LECTURE L1 · UNIT II

Self Determination Theory

Basic psychological needs, the continuum of motivation, and the long debate over whether rewards undermine motivation.

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AFTER THIS LECTURE YOU SHOULD BE ABLE TO

What this lecture prepares you for

- Explain the three basic psychological needs and what satisfies or thwarts them.
- Place a behavior on the continuum from external to intrinsic regulation.
- Evaluate the evidence on whether rewards undermine intrinsic motivation.
- Assess whether autonomy applies in collectivist Indian workplaces.

COURSE OUTCOMES

CLO 3 (evaluate motivation theories and translate them into interventions).

COMMIT BEFORE THEORY

A bonus for every completed appraisal will improve the quality of appraisals.

Agree or disagree, and name the mechanism you are assuming.

THE CORE CLAIM · DECI AND RYAN (2000, 2008)

Three basic psychological needs

AUTONOMY

Experiencing one's actions as self endorsed rather than controlled.

COMPETENCE

Feeling effective and growing in skill.

RELATEDNESS

Feeling connected to and cared for by others.

KEY POINT

Satisfying the needs supports autonomous motivation and wellbeing; thwarting them produces control and ill being.

ORGANISMIC INTEGRATION · GAGNÉ AND DECI (2005)

Motivation is a continuum, not two boxes

Regulation	Why the person acts	Example
External	To gain a reward or avoid punishment	Fills the appraisal form to stop reminders
Introjected	To avoid guilt or protect pride	Fills it to look diligent
Identified	Values the outcome	Sees how feedback helps the team
Integrated	It fits who the person is	Coaching is part of being a manager
Intrinsic	For the activity itself	Enjoys developing people

THEORY IN DEPTH · DECI AND RYAN (2008)

Autonomous versus controlled motivation

THE CORE IDEA

The quality of motivation matters more than the amount: autonomous motivation beats controlled motivation.

HOW IT WORKS

Contexts that support autonomy, competence and relatedness help people internalize goals they did not choose.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Needs are hard to measure apart from their effects; critics question whether they are universal.

IN PRACTICE

A manager who explains why a new safety rule matters gets identified motivation; one who threatens fines gets compliance.

EXAM LENS

Use SDT to judge the quality of motivation a design creates. Weakness: it says less about how much effort a goal will produce.

THEORY IN DEPTH · DECI, KOESTNER AND RYAN (1999)

Do rewards undermine intrinsic motivation?

THE CORE IDEA

Expected tangible rewards for doing a task reduced intrinsic motivation; verbal rewards increased it.

HOW IT WORKS

Rewards experienced as controlling shift motivation toward external regulation; informational rewards support competence.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Cameron and Pierce (1994) argued the negative effects were narrow and limited to specific reward conditions.

IN PRACTICE

Paying per suggestion in a kaizen scheme can raise the number of suggestions while their quality falls.

EXAM LENS

Present both sides of the debate, then use Cerasoli et al. (2014) to resolve it: quality versus quantity.

THEORY IN DEPTH · CERASOLI, NICKLIN AND FORD (2014)

Incentives and intrinsic motivation together

THE CORE IDEA

Intrinsic motivation and extrinsic incentives both predict performance, but for different kinds of work.

HOW IT WORKS

Intrinsic motivation better predicted the quality of performance; incentives better predicted its quantity.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Meta analytic averages hide large differences across tasks and incentive designs.

IN PRACTICE

Piece rates suit a packing line; they suit a design team poorly, where quality depends on interest.

EXAM LENS

Use it to argue that incentive design must match the task. It turns a debate into a design rule.

DOES AUTONOMY TRAVEL? · CHIRKOV ET AL. (2003)

Self determination in collectivist cultures

AUTONOMY IS NOT INDEPENDENCE

A person can autonomously endorse interdependent, family or duty oriented goals.

THE FINDING

Autonomy related to wellbeing across very different cultures.

INDIAN WORKPLACES

The question is not whether people want independence, but whether they endorse what they are asked to do.

COMPARE AND EVALUATE

The appraisal completion bonus, three theories

Theory	Prediction	Risk
Agency theory	Pay aligns effort with the principal's goal	Forms get completed, conversations do not
Self determination	Control shifts motivation toward external regulation	Quantity rises, quality falls
Goal setting	A clear target raises effort on that target	What is not measured is neglected

Jensen and Meckling (1976); Deci et al. (1999); Locke and Latham (2002)

PRACTICE FOR THE END TERM EXAMINATION

Questions to rehearse

"Incentives destroy intrinsic motivation." Critically evaluate with evidence. **20 marks**

A strong answer: presents Deci et al. and Cameron and Pierce; resolves with Cerasoli et al.; distinguishes controlling from informational rewards; applies to a workplace.

Can self determination theory guide performance management in Indian organizations? Discuss. **20 marks**

A strong answer: explains the needs and the continuum; uses Chirkov et al.; addresses hierarchy and duty; proposes autonomy supportive practices.

Distinguish identified from introjected regulation with an example. **10 marks**

A strong answer: precise definitions; a clear workplace example of each; why the difference matters for performance.

CARRY THESE INTO THE EXAMINATION

Three things to remember

1. The quality of motivation matters as much as its amount
2. Controlling rewards raise quantity; autonomy raises quality
3. Autonomy means endorsement, not independence, so it applies in collectivist settings

SET READINGS · FROM THE LESSON PLAN

Read for this lecture

Deci, E. L., & Ryan, R. M. (2008). Self determination theory: A macrotheory of human motivation, development, and health. *Canadian Psychology, 49*(3), 182–185.

Csikszentmihalyi, M. (1990). *Flow: The psychology of optimal experience*. Harper & Row. Chapters 1 to 2.

Pink, D. H. (2009). *Drive: The surprising truth about what motivates us*. Riverhead Books. Chapters 1 to 3.

Luthans, F., Youssef, C. M., & Avolio, B. J. (2007). *Psychological capital: Developing the human competitive edge*. Oxford University Press. Chapter 1.

HOW TO USE THESE

These are the Week 3 set readings. Deci and Ryan (2008) is the core reading for this lecture.

Sources for this lecture (1 of 3)

Works named on the slides of this lecture. They are background sources, not set readings.

Cameron, J., & Pierce, W. D. (1994). Reinforcement, reward, and intrinsic motivation: A meta analysis. *Review of Educational Research, 64*(3), 363–423. https://doi.org/10.3102/00346543064003363

Cerasoli, C. P., Nicklin, J. M., & Ford, M. T. (2014). Intrinsic motivation and extrinsic incentives jointly predict performance: A 40 year meta analysis. *Psychological Bulletin, 140*(4), 980–1008. https://doi.org/10.1037/a0035661

Chirkov, V., Ryan, R. M., Kim, Y., & Kaplan, U. (2003). Differentiating autonomy from individualism and independence: A self determination theory perspective on internalization of cultural orientations and well being. *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology, 84*(1), 97–110. https://doi.org/10.1037/0022-3514.84.1.97

Sources for this lecture (2 of 3)

Deci, E. L., & Ryan, R. M. (2000). The "what" and "why" of goal pursuits: Human needs and the self determination of behavior. *Psychological Inquiry, 11*(4), 227–268. https://doi.org/10.1207/s15327965pli1104_01

Deci, E. L., & Ryan, R. M. (2008). Self determination theory: A macrotheory of human motivation, development, and health. *Canadian Psychology, 49*(3), 182–185. https://doi.org/10.1037/a0012801

Deci, E. L., Koestner, R., & Ryan, R. M. (1999). A meta analytic review of experiments examining the effects of extrinsic rewards on intrinsic motivation. *Psychological Bulletin, 125*(6), 627–668. https://doi.org/10.1037/0033-2909.125.6.627

Sources for this lecture (3 of 3)

Gagné, M., & Deci, E. L. (2005). Self determination theory and work motivation. *Journal of Organizational Behavior, 26*(4), 331–362. https://doi.org/10.1002/job.322

Jensen, M. C., & Meckling, W. H. (1976). Theory of the firm: Managerial behavior, agency costs and ownership structure. *Journal of Financial Economics, 3*(4), 305–360. https://doi.org/10.1016/0304-405x(76)90026-x

Locke, E. A., & Latham, G. P. (2002). Building a practically useful theory of goal setting and task motivation: A 35 year odyssey. *American Psychologist, 57*(9), 705–717. https://doi.org/10.1037/0003-066x.57.9.705